WEEK 13 / FUTURE DIRECTIONS AND SYNTHESIS

Virtual Reality, AI, and the Future of Gaming

The role of XR and AI in creating lifelike environments.

This week, we explore the role of virtual reality (VR), augmented reality (AR), mixed reality (MR), and artificial intelligence (AI) in creating immersive and lifelike gaming environments. We will discuss the technological advancements and their impact on player experience.

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23 RESOURCES / 1 TOPIC

TOPIC 01

Immersive Technology and AI

REQUIRED

Video game performers are on strike - and AI is the sticking point

ARTICLE/AUDIO | ~12 MIN

https://www.npr.org/2024/08/02/1198912993/video-games-ai-artificial-intelligence-warner-bros-strike

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.
LO 4: Students will be able to discuss ethical concerns surrounding gaming, including issues related to violence, addiction, monetization practices, labor concerns, and virtual identities.
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REQUIRED

SAG-AFTRA receives bipartisan congressional support for anti-deepfake and AI act

ARTICLE | ~3 MIN

https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/sag-aftra-receives-congress-bipartisan-support-for-anti-deepfake-and-ai-act?sp_aid=129083&elq_cid=48662221&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&utm_source=eloqua&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_04.10.25&sp_cid=57510&utm_content=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_04.10.25

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REQUIRED

Report: Candy Crush maker King is allegedly replacing laid off employees with AI tools

ARTICLE | ~3 MIN

https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/report-candy-crush-maker-king-is-allegedly-replacing-employees-with-internal-ai-tools?_mc=Gama_NL18072025&cid=Gama_NL18072025&sp_aid=130745&elq_cid=48662221&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&utm_source=eloqua&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_07.18.25&sp_cid=58704&utm_content=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_07.18.25

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REQUIRED

History of AI in Games - Video Game - F.E.A.R

BLOG POST WITH 2 YOUTUBE VIDEOS | ~25 MIN

https://modl.ai/fear/

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REQUIRED

The Darth Vader Fortnite AI DISASTER

YOUTUBE | ~12 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gfcpb-sKvUg

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REQUIRED

VR and AI in Education: The Future of Learning

TED TALK | ~13 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XGkWh4v1hCE&ab_channel=TEDxTalks

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REQUIRED

Philip Rosedale: Second Life, where anything is possible

TED TALK | ~29 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lHXXsEtE3b4

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REQUIRED

How immersive technologies (AR/VR) will shape our future

TED TALK | ~13 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QcANba_1xg8&ab_channel=TEDxTalks

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REQUIRED

Immersive Gaming! | Imp And Skizz Podcast (Ep82), especially the first 4 minutes

PODCAST/YOUTUBE | 4 MIN - 55 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KEuuscx1VTY&ab_channel=ImpAndSkizzPodcast

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REQUIRED

A Gamer Looks At 40 Ep 117: Side Quests Vol 9, from 1:20 to 7:20

PODCAST CLIP | ~6 MIN

https://www.buzzsprout.com/1426576/episodes/15949708?t=80

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REQUIRED

Interactivity in immersive spaces : an art & tech journey

YOUTUBE | ~33 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a65TW9toG-E&ab_channel=Augmenta

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EXPLORE FURTHER

Ready Player One by Ernest Cline

BOOK

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/2sp9f6/alma991008066629708681

EXPLORE FURTHER

Ready Player One

MOVIE

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/2sp9f6/alma991023937949708681

EXPLORE FURTHER

Three States and a Plan: The A.I. of F.E.A.R. by Jeff Orkin

ACADEMIC PAPER

https://www.gamedevs.org/uploads/three-states-plan-ai-of-fear.pdf

EXPLORE FURTHER

Best AI in Video Games Review

BLOG POST

https://vanceai.com/posts/best-ai-in-video-games-review/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Talking to Smart AI NPCs in Unreal Engine 5 (The Future of Gaming & Artificial Intelligence)

YOUTUBE | 10 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4sCWf2VGdfc&ab_channel=TmarTn2

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EXPLORE FURTHER

Igloo Vision Demos Igloo Vision Immersive Space for Education and Enterprise

YOUTUBE | 3 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-JaXgEEiLbo

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EXPLORE FURTHER

Circle of Life / Breathtaking Immersive Experience of Nature and Light

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q3iIOpijMV4&ab_channel=Limelight

EXPLORE FURTHER

Crafting immersive spaces with virtual tracking systems | Naostage booth showcase | ISE 2024

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YBdVPidzlLQ&ab_channel=Inavate

EXPLORE FURTHER

I Tried Real Augmented Reality Glasses!

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G0eKzU_fV00&ab_channel=MarquesBrownlee

EXPLORE FURTHER

Second Life Community Roundtable with Philip Rosedale Replay

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1w9al7GcjV8

EXPLORE FURTHER

How augmented reality will change sports ... and build empathy

TED TALK | 10 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AgMOJC5R4F8

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EXPLORE FURTHER

The VR Dilemma: How AR and VR redefine our reality

TED TALK | 14 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zOBiZrTomso&ab_channel=TEDxTalks

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